Military mobility talks make progress

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【要点】

・EU交渉担当者は軍事移動ルールの進展を遂行したが、12月の期限までに政治的に敏感な問題が未解決のままである。

・新しい緊急措置により、軍事輸送は通常の交通規制が適用される時間帯（週末、祝日、夜間など）でも移動が可能になる見込みである。

・異常な軍事輸送について、受け入れ国が必要な交通手配を行うことを条件に、通常の重量・寸法制限を超えることが認められた。

・軍事工兵部隊は、軍事移動に必要な場合、環境保全措置を前提に通常の民間許可なしに仮設橋など一時的インフラの設置が可能となる。

・各国は軍事輸送の実行可能性を評価し、軍事移動の準備状況を定期的にチェックする必要がある。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By MARTINA SAPIO with JORDYN DAHL SNEAK PEEK — EU negotiators have made progres

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By MARTINA SAPIO

with JORDYN DAHL

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SNEAK PEEK

— EU negotiators have made progress on military mobility rules, but politically sensitive issues remain unresolved ahead of a looming December deadline.

— EU countries remain divided over which trading partners should qualify as “Made in Europe” under the IAA, but nuanced stances are emerging.

—VW subsidiary Audi opens the door for further job cuts due to a sharp dropoff in China sales.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

EXCLUSIVE — MILITARY MOBILITY TALKS DRAG ON: EU negotiators have made progress on rules meant to move troops and military equipment more quickly across Europe in a crisis, including new

emergency measures. However, they still have no deal on the solidarity pool of shared transport and logistics assets, according to late-October trilogue documents seen by Martina.

Where things stand: The last formal trilogue took place on Oct. 20, with technical work continuing since then. Negotiators are now heading toward a final trilogue on Dec. 9, the deadline for resolving the remaining political issues.

Emergency mode: The emerging deal would allow military road movements to continue during weekends, public holidays, nighttime and other periods normally covered by traffic restrictions, although receiving countries could still impose exceptions for safety reasons. Military rail vehicles used during an EMERS crisis response activation could be exempted from certain railway noise restrictions, while countries would also coordinate exemptions for dangerous-goods transport and other emergency movements.

Heavy kit: Negotiators have also agreed rules allowing abnormal military road transport to exceed normal weight or dimension limits during an activation, provided the receiving country sets the necessary traffic arrangements, including specific routes where needed. Another agreed provision would let military engineering units install temporary infrastructure such as modular bridges and crossings without first obtaining some ordinary civil permits, where necessary for military movements and subject to national law and essential environmental safeguards.

Readiness checks: Countries would carry out regular Military Transport Readiness Checks to assess whether they can actually execute military movements and whether the national measures needed to implement EMERS are in place. National military transport coordinators would also have a formal role in handling priority-access requests during an activation and coordinating the national, regional and local actors involved in getting military movements through without undue delay.

Brussels command room: The Military Mobility Transport Group is also taking shape as the forum for countries to coordinate, exchange information and issue opinions, advice and recommendations on how the system should work.

But the pool is still waiting: The Solidarity Pool — designed to make dual-use transport and logistics capabilities available for military movements — remains one of the big unresolved pieces.

What's envisioned: The draft would create a pool of registered transport and logistics assets from member countries, potentially backed by a secure digital platform and used to plug capability gaps when military transport demand surges.

Still no landing zone: But the latest text does not yet show agreement on the core Solidarity Pool provisions, including how capabilities are registered, how the pool is managed and the conditions under which those assets can be called on — leaving one of the regulation's most operationally important elements for the next stage of negotiations.

INDUSTRIAL ACCELERATOR ACT

STILL DIVIDED ON 'MADE IN EUROPE': EU countries remain divided over which trading partners should qualify under the "Made in Europe" provisions of the Industrial Accelerator Act, according to readouts of last week's two-day working party obtained by POLITICO.

Disappointment: The meetings were the first opportunity for diplomats to react to the Franco-German deal that saw Paris give ground on emission reduction targets in exchange for support from Berlin on a

stricter definition of who qualifies as “Made in Europe.” While the agreement unlocked negotiations in the European Parliament, it did little to move the needle in the Council meetings.

Dividing lines: The broad camps haven’t shifted much on their stances of determining whether products from third countries qualify as partner origin, although nuances are emerging. France wants a narrow club, with Spain, Greece and Italy broadly supportive, albeit less restrictive, according to one readout. A middle group favors a relatively open regime subject to reciprocity conditions. Sweden, and to some extent the Netherlands, favor a more open approach with softer reciprocity requirements.

It’s a no from us: The Franco-German deal also proposed removing the automotive provisions from the IAA and instead putting them under the Automotive Package. The IAA is intrinsically linked with the proposed reform of the 2035 de facto combustion engine ban, along with other automotive regulations like corporate fleets. Most member countries opposed such a change, the readout said.

Broader definition: A coalition of countries want research and development to be included when calculating a vehicle’s EU content, though the Commission said it would be difficult to quantify. Under the IAA proposal, at least 70% of the value of a car’s components — excluding the battery — must originate in the EU.

Who’s in? The Commission presented an initial assessment of the 20 or so countries that could qualify as trusted partners under the reciprocity criteria, including Japan, Turkey and South Korea.

Pick your own reciprocity recipe: The Irish presidency presented three options for determining whether a third country treats EU products like theirs are treated in the bloc. A large number of countries supported the option that reflects the Irish presidency’s latest compromise, which would base reciprocity on third countries being part of the WTO General Procurement Agreement or having a free-trade agreement with the EU.

A busy month: Deputy ambassadors will discuss the IAA on Nov. 11. The fourth compromise text from the Irish presidency is set to land on Nov. 16, the substance of which will be discussed by the member countries in another working party on Nov. 18. The presidency has penciled in Nov. 27 to wrap up the final negotiations.

CARS

MORE CUTS LOOM AT AUDI: The Volkswagen subsidiary opened the door for further job cuts on Friday after it presented its third quarter earnings . Last year’s restructuring measures that cut 7,500 jobs are no longer sufficient, the German automaker said, and additional steps will now be negotiated with its works council. “We are setting clear priorities: reducing costs while increasing quality and productivity,” CEO Gernot Döllner told investors.

China strikes again: Audi joined its fellow automakers in revealing a further dwindling of sales in China. Parent company Volkswagen saw its sales decline 31% year-over-year in the third quarter. Audi fared even worse, with its sales dropping 35% from 147,000 in the third quarter of 2025 to 96,000 this year.

Tariffs hurt: New trade measures from the United States cost Audi €1.2 billion last year. The automaker did not give a specific figure on what it has paid so far this year, telling investors that tariffs continue to weigh on earnings. But the impact is driving its decision to invest €4 billion in a U.S. plant in Georgia — a plan it announced at a campaign rally that still needs to be approved by VW’s supervisory board.

Potential deal: Reuters reported on Friday that the U.S. plans to give tariff relief to automakers that make “significant” investments in the country. European automakers have lobbied for the U.S. to offset tariffs based on their U.S. investments and to give credits for the number of cars they export from the U.S. to other markets. Mercedes-Benz CEO Ola Källenius told media last week that “there is currently no clearly formulated policy in the U.S. that would allow for investment credits to offset tariffs,” but it is a policy the company has advocated for.

No comment: When asked about a potential deal on automotive tariffs on Friday, the European Commission declined to comment.

CHARGE UP YOUR HYBRID: As promised, the EU opened a safeguards investigation into worldwide imports of hybrid vehicles on Friday. The probe is the formal implementation of a pre-arranged quota the bloc will impose on China, allowing up to 350,000 such cars into the EU market for 2027.

Why so soon? The launch comes rather early, considering the Commission has said several times it wants to impose measures from Dec. 1. By the letter of the law, the Commission could legally impose safeguard measures on the very same day as the opening of an investigation. “You open yourself up for comments from all sides,” a Brussels-based trade lawyer told our colleague Koen Verhelst. They were granted anonymity to discuss Commission tactics.

Complaints window: Interested parties now have 21 days to submit a reaction to the investigation. “The only downside of initiating and imposing measures on the same day is that the provisional measures can only last for 200 days,” the lawyer explained.

PIT STOPS

Russia is testing exporting grain through the Arctic port of Murmansk, as Ukraine’s drone campaign has all but cut off its traditional route via the Black Sea.

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